Book of Abstract

ICESDA 2024

1st INTERNATIONAL CONFERENCE ON ENVIRONMENT, SOCIAL, GOVERNANCE AND SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT OF AFRICA

Theme

Enhancing Environment, Social, Governance and Sustainability (ESGS) for Africa's Development

Date: 26th -29th March 2024

Venue: University Accomodation and Conferences Centre @ the Impact Building, KNUST, Kumasi

Foreword

Welcome to the inaugural edition of the International Conference on Environment, Social Governance (ESG), and Sustainable Development in Africa. This momentous event brings together scholars, professionals, industry leaders, and policy-makers from across the globe to deliberate on critical issues pertaining to Africa's sustainable development.

Africa, with its rich resources, diverse cultures, and vibrant economies, stands at a pivotal juncture in its history. As we navigate the challenges of the 21st century, we must prioritise sustainable practices that promote environmental stewardship, social progress, and effective governance. This conference serves as a vital platform for knowledge exchange, collaboration, and inspiration towards these shared objectives.

Under the overarching theme of ESG and sustainable development, this conference encompasses a wide array of tracks that address key areas of concern in Africa. The tracks have been carefully curated to encompass topics of utmost relevance and urgency. They explore the sustainability of the Africa Continental Free Trade Area, scrutinise the ESG and sustainability practices of public and private sector institutions, delve into social innovations, entrepreneurship, and indigenous knowledge management, and examine sustainable innovations in various domains such as the built environment ecosystem, urban configuration and mobility, plastics and marine pollution, textiles and microfiber technology, and climate-smart agricultural technology.

By convening experts from academia, industry, and government, we aim to foster interdisciplinary dialogues and facilitate the exchange of innovative ideas, research findings, and practical experiences. Through these exchanges, we hope to generate actionable insights, policies, and strategies that drive positive change and contribute to Africa's sustainable development agenda.

In addition to the scholarly contributions, this conference proudly showcases the participation of industry leaders, corporate bodies, and political figures from Ghana and beyond. Their presence and involvement further emphasise the importance of collaboration between different sectors in tackling the complex challenges we face.

We extend our deepest gratitude to all the contributors, presenters, and attendees who have dedicated their time, expertise, and enthusiasm to make this conference a reality. Your collective commitment to advancing sustainable development in Africa is truly commendable, and we are honoured to have you join us in this endeavour.

As we embark on this intellectual journey, let us embrace the spirit of collaboration, inclusivity, and innovation. May this conference catalyse transformative action, inspiring us to create a more sustainable, equitable, and prosperous future for Africa and its people.

We wish you a productive and enlightening conference experience.

Sincerely,

Prof. De-Graft Owusu-Manu

Conference Chair

ICESDA

Acknowledgements

We would like to express our sincere gratitude and appreciation to all the individuals and organisations who have contributed to the successful organisation and execution of the maiden edition of the International Conference on Environment, Social Governance, and Sustainable Development in Africa. Your unwavering support, dedication, and hard work have been instrumental in making this conference a resounding success.

We extend our heartfelt thanks to the distinguished individuals who graced us with their presence and delivered inspiring opening addresses. Prof. (Mrs.) Rita Akosua Dickson, Vice Chancellor of Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology, Prof. John Owusu, Vice Chancellor of Koforidua Technical University, Prof. John Tia Bugri, Provost of the College of Art and Built Environment at KNUST, Prof. Joshua Ayarkwa, Former Provost of the College of Art and Built Environment at Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology, Prof. Edward Badu, Former Provost of the College of Art and Built Environment at Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology, Hon. Simon Osei Mensah, Ashanti Regional Minister, Hon. Abraham Antwi, Municipal Chief Executive of Oforikrom Municipal Assembly-Kumasi, and Engr. Henry Kwadwo Boateng, President of the Institute of Engineering and Technology-Ghana, your insightful contributions have set the tone for the conference and provided invaluable perspectives.

We would also like to express our gratitude to Prof. Rexford Assassie Oppong from the Department of Architecture at KNUST for his enlightening presentation on the Adinkratecture of the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGS) via the Adinkra Symbology. Your ground breaking presentation has added significant depth to the conference discussions and has furthered our understanding of sustainable development in Africa.

A special word of appreciation goes to all the authors who have contributed their scientific papers to this conference. Your dedication, expertise, and valuable insights have enriched the conference proceedings and fostered meaningful dialogue on environmental, social, governance, and sustainable development issues in Africa. We are also grateful to the reviewers who have diligently evaluated the papers and provided valuable feedback. We mention our International, Local and Technical Universities Advisory Boards whose wise counsel have brought us this far.

Our heartfelt thanks go to the Conference Secretariat, led by Prof. De-Graft Owusu-Manu as Chairman, Prof. Ernest Ofori Asamoah, Dr. Christian Sewordor Mensah, Dr. Yaw Amo Sarpong, Dr. Kenneth Donkor-Hyiaman, Dr. Eric Oduro Ofori, Dr. Alexander Acheampong, Dr. Michael Adesi, and Mrs. Matilda Owusu-Manu. Your outstanding leadership, coordination, and tireless efforts have been vital in ensuring the smooth organisation and execution of the conference.

We extend our deepest appreciation to the Sponsorship and Funds Raising Committee, chaired by Mr. Abraham Lincoln Kwame Owusu, and comprising of Dr. Christian Sewordor Mensah, Mrs. Thelma N.A. Maclean Apenteng, Dr. Yaw Amo Sarpong, Mr. Daniel Kontie, Dr. (Mrs.) Anita Adade Boateng, Mrs. Matilda Owusu-Manu, Mr. Ebenezer Eghan Duncan, and Engr. Henry Kwadwo Boateng. Your dedication in securing sponsorships and managing the financial aspects of the conference has been invaluable.

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We would like to extend our heartfelt thanks to the Event Planning Coordinators, chaired by Dr. Kenneth Donkor-Hyiaman and assisted by Mr. Abraham Lincoln Kwame Owusu, Engr. Henry Boateng, Mr. Daniel Kontie, Mr. Ebenezer Eghan Duncan, Engr. Seth Ayim, Dr. (Mrs.) Ivy M.A. Abu, Mr. David Kwadwo Marfo, and Mr. Adam Braimah Jehuri. Your exceptional efforts in organising and managing the logistics of the conference have ensured a seamless and memorable experience for all participants.

The Branding and Social Media Committee, chaired by Dr. Christian Sewordor Mensah, and comprising of Mr. Eugene Osei-Tutu and Dr. Francis Kofi Nimo Nunoo, deserves special recognition for their outstanding efforts in promoting the conference and facilitating effective communication through various media channels.

We are thankful to our dedicated ICT team lead by Mr. Christopher Add and Mr. Selorm Gabriel Tamakloe who set up and managed the ICT infrastructure systems before, during and after the conference. Guys, you were simply fabulous on the job. Thank you. We thank our video production and photography team – Mr. Prosper Blege (Studio 225), Mr. Edem Casmel Sallah (KNUST), Mr. Emmanuel Osei (LUV FM) and Ms. Anita Adzoga (LUV FM) for their unwavering support.

I would like to make a special mention to the following individuals who in diverse ways supported the conference and gave us courage and hope to pursue this dream: Prof, David John Edwards of Birmingham City University, Prof. Joshua Ayarkwa (KNUST), Prof. Edward Badu (KNUST), Rev. (Prof.) Michael Twum Darko (Cape Peninsula University of Technology), Aps. (Prof.) Joseph Ingnatius Teye Buertey (Pentecost University), Prof. Emmanuel Bamfo-Adjei (Cape Coast technical University), Prof. Francis. K. Bondinuba (Kumasi Technical University), Prof. Richard Ohene Asiedu (Koforidua Technical University).

Lastly, we express our deepest gratitude to the Protocol Team, led by Dr. (Mrs.) Anita Adade Boateng and Mr. Alexander Baah Amoakwa, and supported by Dr. (Mrs.) Ivy M.A. Abu, Mrs. Matilda Owusu-Manu, and Mr. Adam Braimah Jehuri. Your professionalism, attention to detail, and commitment to ensuring a smooth and welcoming experience for all participants are truly commendable.

We would also like to acknowledge the contributions of all the volunteers, administrative staff, technical support teams, and other individuals who have worked tirelessly behind the scenes to make this conference a success.

Last but not the least, we acknowledge the contributions and support from our strategic partners including all professional groups and associations that collaborated with Green Communities International to deliver ICESDA 2024. The list is endless but to mention a few, we thank the following: Department of Construction Technology and Management (KNUST), Walter Sisulu University (South Africa); University of Johannesburg (South Africa), Institute of Engineering and Technology (IET-Gh), Ghana Institute of Construction (GIOC), Construction Industry Development Institute (CIDI),

Training Innovations and Technology Transfer Institute, Global Institute of Mindset Transformation and Attitudinal Change, Oxford Business Group, African Continental Engineering and Construction Network, Real Estate and Construction Conference, International Conference on African Mindset Transformation and System Thinking (ICAMTST), International Conference on Business and Management Dynamics, Bamboo Eco-City Project, African Centre of Business Incubation, Chamber of Agribusiness Ghana (CAG), Top Technocrats (Gh) Limited, Jannika Organic Agro Business Limited, Jannika Foods Processing Ltd, Business Angels Limited, Yummy Premium Bakery. We also acknowledge Infusion Africa, ICBMD and Mobex Africa who initially played various roles. We hope, you will be able to play significant roles in future events.

We acknowledge and thank our media partners: Joy News, LUV FM, Nhyira FM, CITI News, TV3 and the University Relations Office (URO-KNUST) who have generously given us a wider media coverage before, during and after the conference. We appreciate the contributions of Mr. Rija Niaina Ramahatafandry from Oxford Business Group and Mr. Gustav Addo (CEO of Africa Global Times). Though you joined late, your contribution was impactful.

We profoundly thank the various individuals, organisations, suppliers and service-providers who provided various services to make ICESDA 2024 a memorable one. Specifically, we thank the University Accommodation and Conferences Center for giving us this beautiful conference facility. We thank Dr. Kwabena Asubonteng, Dr. Moro Ismaila, Mr. Stephen Nusesi Ameyibor, Mr. Cyril Elikem Agboyie (SmartTags) for supplying us with the various Souvenirs for the conference.

Finally, and most significantly, we express our sincere appreciation to all the sponsors, funding organisations, and institutions that have generously supported this conference. You gave ICESDA 2024 blood to live. In particular, we thank Fedems Group of Companies. Ghana Civil Aviation Authority, Asib Construction Ltd, Fidelity Bank Limited, McDan Group of Companies and Jospong Group of Companies. Your financial contributions and support have played a pivotal role in making this event possible. We humbly ask for more in the subsequent events.

To everyone mentioned above and to all those who have contributed in any way, we thank you from the bottom of our hearts. Your contributions have been invaluable in advancing the goals of this conference and fostering dialogue and collaboration towards a sustainable future for Africa.

Thank you.

Prof. De-Graft Owusu-Manu

Conference Chair

AI Camera Systems For HFR: Development Of A Test Standard And Field Trials

Prof. David John Edwards
Birmingham City University
Birmingham-UK

Abstract

Preserving health, safety, and welfare is instrumental to any sustainability agenda and removing people from risks posed by work activities is top of the safety risk hierarchy of control measures. This keynote presentation discusses the results of work designed to develop a standardised test to measure the accuracy of artificial intelligence (AI) camera systems fitted to 360° tracked hydraulic excavators when detecting the physical form of human beings in various positions and postures (e.g. standing and crouching) within the machine's operational envelope. Almost 6,000 readings were taken in what is the most comprehensive study of its kind undertaken to date. A 1m x 1m grid system was marked onto hard standing around the operational area of a 13.5 tonne machine and extended to 5m out from the machine on three sides (driver's side, tailgate and offside). A 2m area (the inner zone) immediately adjacent to and around the machine was set within the AI camera system, indicating an area with an extremely high risk of physical contact from human incursions. A further 3m area (2-5m from the machine – the outer zone) was also included in the camera system to indicate a high-risk area. The research study applied the tests to two competitor systems to enable a comparative analysis to be undertaken. Test results showed 95.12% (Company A) and 93.69% (Company B) accuracy overall for dynamic tests that involved standing, crouching and standing holding a box. Examination of the individual zone results showed Company A to have an overall inner zone accuracy of 98.04% and an overall outer zone accuracy of 93.83% for the dynamic tests and Company B to have an overall inner zone accuracy of 93.14% and an overall outer zone accuracy of 93.94%. No significant difference was therefore observed between the two systems, and both had similar predictive accuracy. For tests that sought to obscure the human form, accuracy overall was reduced to 51.14% (Company A) and 63.64% (Company B), albeit accuracy within the 2m area immediately adjacent to and around the machine was considerably higher for both Company A and Company B at 80.56% and 86.11% respectively. A walking test around the grid area was also undertaken and revealed that a walk of 1-2m distance into the grid (from the outside 5m edge) could be reached (dependent upon the speed of walking) before the audible alarm of both systems was activated. Notably, the walking test subject did not reach the extremely high-risk danger area of 2m around the machine. Some limitations of both the test procedure and the AI camera systems were noted. For example, the system could not be tested on mobile machines so further research is ideally needed here. In conclusion, AI camera systems present a notable advancement in the safety devices fitted to excavators, but this should not reduce the need for safe systems of working (such as pedestrian exclusion zones) and other devices fitted to machinery (for example, pencil beam or convex mirrors). Further advancements are most likely given the rapid pace of technological developments, and so the test standard developed should be implemented as and when the next generation of AI systems is made available or as new alternative products enter the market. This keynote speech is, therefore time-bound and will require periodic updating.

We have plenty, yet hungry: Institutional arrangements in meeting the SDG 1 and 2 by ending poverty and hunger

Dr. Christian Sewordor Mensah
Executive Director, African Centre for Business Incubation

Abstract

Meeting the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) of ending poverty and hunger requires effective institutional arrangements that coordinate efforts and promote collaboration among various stakeholders. These institutional arrangements play a crucial role in addressing the complex and multi-dimensional nature of poverty and hunger. One of the key institutional arrangements to address these goals is the establishment of government agencies and departments responsible for poverty alleviation and food security. These institutions coordinate and implement policies, programs, and interventions at national, regional, and local levels. They develop strategies and allocate resources to address the root causes of poverty and hunger, such as lack of access to education, health services, and productive resources like land and credit. International organisations also play a vital role in institutional arrangements to achieve SDGs 1 and 2. Organisations like the United Nations, World Bank, and International Monetary Fund provide technical support, financial resources, and expertise to countries in their efforts to eradicate poverty and hunger. They facilitate knowledge sharing, capacity building, and policy advocacy to enhance the effectiveness of national efforts. Non-governmental organisations (NGOs) and civil society organisations are key players in the institutional arrangements as well. They work alongside governments to implement development projects, advocate for policy change, and empower local communities. NGOs often have a strong presence at the grassroots level and can fill gaps in service delivery, particularly in remote and marginalised areas. In addition to these institutions, partnerships and collaborations between different stakeholders are essential for achieving SDGs 1 and 2. Multi-stakeholder platforms, such as public-private partnerships, bring together businesses, academia, civil society, and government to pool resources, share expertise, and develop innovative solutions. These partnerships foster inclusive decision-making and ensure a comprehensive approach to poverty and hunger eradication. Furthermore, monitoring and evaluation mechanisms are crucial in institutional arrangements to track progress towards SDGs 1 and 2. National statistical agencies, research institutions, and other data collection bodies monitor poverty and hunger indicators, identify gaps, and provide evidence-based recommendations for policy improvement. Regular assessments help to identify successful interventions and areas that require further attention. Overall, institutional arrangements that promote collaboration, coordination, and knowledge sharing are vital for meeting the SDGs of ending poverty and hunger. These arrangements ensure effective integration of efforts and resources, enhance accountability and enable sustainable development outcomes. By establishing robust institutional frameworks, countries can tackle poverty and hunger more comprehensively and achieve lasting results.

Destruction of Fresh Water Bodies In Africa: Is There A Solution?

Dr. Ben Asante
Lecturer, Ghana Communication Technology University

Abstract

Water is an extremely important necessity in the lives of human beings. As much as some parts of the continent of Africa are endowed with many water bodies, other parts of the continent have very scanty of this resource. It is rather unfortunate that some parts of the continent that have abundant water bodies have neglected to take good care of them. The citizenry of the countries having an abundance of water bodies conduct activities that are destroying them in their respective countries. The activities include illegal dumping of refuse into water bodies, illegal mining in water bodies, illegal dumping of chemicals into water bodies, and the filling of water bodies to build places of abode. Other activities include spillage of oil into the waters, illegal dumping of plastics in the surrounding environment of the water bodies, and a host of other activities that do not assist in the preservation of the water bodies. Lawmakers and political leaders of these nations have put measures in place to curb the destruction of the water bodies, but the destruction continues unabated. Nevertheless, do we need to sit aloof to allow the current trend to continue? The answer is a resounding no. Something can be done about the situation. It is incumbent on all Africans to come together to enact laws about the destruction of the water bodies in Africa. Moreover, this law has to bind all African nations. The violating country, in accordance with the laws, irrespective of their economic power, must be served the applicable punitive measures. This has to be done without fear or favour. Undoubtedly, if stringent measures are not put in place to seize these nefarious activities, it is envisioned that in the near future, water may elude even the countries that have plenty of water bodies.

Abstracts/Highlights of Keynote and Guest Speakers (Industry)

Keeping the Menace: The Sustainable Way (The Case of Kpone Landfill, Accra Ghana)

Ing. Felix K. Atsrim
Chief Executive Officer of FeDems Group, Ghana

Abstract

The created order is always involved in creating a menace. The process of creating the basic essential needs of human life (food, clothing, shelter, work, mobility, etc) always results in the generation of a menace (waste), that needs to be carefully managed. Approximately 12,710 tons of waste is generated daily in Ghana with only 10% of this waste being managed properly. The challenge therefore is the efficient and sustainable means of waste collection, disposal and management in Ghana. Sustainability has become a common word but with little understanding due to the very many definitions that create misinterpretation and confusion. Many recent dialogues on sustainability are more skewed towards sustainable development rather than focusing on sustainability as a composite. Gray (2010), distinguishes between 'sustainability' and 'sustainable development' as two analogues; and holds that the difference between the two expressions is that, 'sustainability' refers to a state, while 'sustainable development' refers to the process of achieving this state. This research discusses models used to transform a consciously created menace at the Kpone landfill into a 'sustainable mine' as a means of preserving our ecology. This research therefore proposes that the drive towards environmental sustainability must begin with prioritizing education and public awareness whilst enhancing stakeholder collaboration and efficient policy promulgation and enforcement. Again, it is important to establish proper waste collection systems, recycling facilities, and disposal sites whilst embracing the principles of a circular economy using innovative technologies and processes to transform waste into valuable resources. By adopting strategic, efficient and sustainable waste management practices, Ghana can mitigate environmental impact, promote economic growth, and maintain a harmonious balance between waste disposal and resource conservation, and a better future for all.

Keywords: keeping, Menace, Sustainable, sustainability, circular economy

Promoting and Celebrating Excellence in Sustainability among African Brands: The Collective Responsibility of Both Public and Private Sector Stakeholders

Mr. Daniel Kontie

Chief Executive Officer of Africa Continental Engineering & Construction Network Ltd, Ghana

Abstract

Promoting and celebrating excellence in sustainability among African brands: the collective responsibility of both public and private sector stakeholders is a composite mix design of contemporary marketing and business development strategy that is informed by industry trends and anchored on science and data. It was against this backdrop that the Africa Continental Engineering and Construction Network (ACECN) introduced the African Continental Sustainability Built Environment Excellence Awards (ACSBEEA), the first of its kind in Ghana to give an opportunity to brands such as the Green Communities International and its programme, the ICESDA, both local and international recognition using this innovative awards and testimonial scheme. According to Jyoti (2023), winning an award has a multi-dimensional positive effect on the psychology of both the winner and the potential user of the product or service of the winner. Apart from its core mandate that focuses on built environment sustainability and the mitigation of the negative impact of climate change, ACECN introduced this award and testimonial scheme to promote and give recognition to African sustainable brands. The focus has always been on both private and public sector stakeholders; hence our awards for last year witnessed the recognition of close to twenty (20) awardees from private and public sector institutions, such as the Climate Change Department at the Ministry of Finance, Kumasi Academy and some private sector institutions such as the Adom City Estate, GM Bamboo Eco-City to mention a few. Private individuals who champion the sustainability agenda were also given the same recognition. The world has come to a point where we can no longer do things the same old way that has brought us to this global climate change quagmire. That is why we at the AECN is committed to supporting this global agenda using this awards and testimonial scheme as a strategy. We therefore urge all corporate institutions and individuals here, private or public, to visit our website to submit entries for the 2024 Built Environment Excellence Awards scheduled to take place in October 2024. On this note, we would like to thank Green Communities International for this initiative, and we must admit that ICESDA 2024 is a success; therefore, the organiser, Green Communities International, deserves recognition in our sustainability awards come October 2024. Long live Green Communities International! Long live the Africa Continental Engineering and Construction Network! Long live Africa! Long Live Ghana! Long live the Great Ashanti Kingdom!

Corporate Social Responsibility: A catalyst for Socio-economic and Community Development of Africa

Abdel-Razak Yakubu
Executive Secretary
Gold Fields Ghana Foundation (Tarkwa and Damang)

Abstract

Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) has emerged as an important force in contemporary business strategies. Businesses must go beyond mere profit-making objectives to deliberately pursue broader social impacts and influence. This presentation examines the role of CSR as a catalyst for community development, exploring its significance in fostering sustainable socio-economic growth. CSR encompasses ethical practices and addresses pressing social and environmental issues while simultaneously enhancing reputations and stakeholder relationships. Through case studies and analysis of actual practice, the discussions will highlight the multifaceted ways in which CSR initiatives contribute to community empowerment and development, ranging from philanthropic endeavours to the implementation of strategic development plans for local community development. Furthermore, it delves into the challenges and opportunities faced by corporations in implementing impactful CSR programmes. It emphasises the need for collaboration between businesses, governments, and civil society to maximise positive outcomes. Ultimately, the presentation discusses the transformative potential of CSR in driving holistic community development and advocates for its integration into mainstream business strategies.

Our Sustainability Journey

Mrs. Majorie Quansah[1] and Mr. Samuel Kweku Kumah[2]
[1]*Corporate Social Responsibility Coordinator, Fidelity Bank Ghana*
[2]*Research and Impact Management Officer, Fidelity Bank Ghana*

Abstract

In a world where consumers, investors, and regulators increasingly demand transparency, environmental responsibility, and social accountability, Fidelity Bank acknowledges that embracing sustainability is not just a moral imperative but a strategic necessity. As a top-tier financial institution in Ghana, Fidelity Bank recognises the urgency of transitioning towards sustainability in the modern world. Our rationale for embarking on this transformative journey can be encapsulated in the following: (i) Environmental Degradation: Climate change, resource depletion, and ecosystem degradation threaten our planet, (ii) Social Inequality: Disparities in access to financial services hinder global economic participation, and (iii) Ethical Expectations: Society demands responsible corporate behaviour. The Sustainability Vision for Fidelity Bank is to create a sustainable future for all Ghanaians by supporting inclusive economic growth, reducing our environmental footprint, maintaining high standards of governance and ethics, and engaging with our stakeholders to build trust and foster long-term partnerships.

List of Awardees

A. Best Paper Awards

1. Overall Best Paper Award
2. 1st Runner-Up Paper Award
3. 2nd Best Paper Award

B. Creativity, Innovativeness and Novelty Award

C. Best Presentation Award

1. The Overall Best Paper Presentation Award
2. 1st Runner-Up Best Paper Presentation
3. 2nd Runner-Up Best Paper Presentation

D. Excellent Service and Commitment to Duty Award

1. Dr. Christian Sewordor Mensah, Green Communities International/ICESDA
2. Mr. Abraham Lincoln Kwame Owusu, Green Communities International/ICESDA
3. Dr. Michael Adesi, Green Communities International/ICESDA/KNUST
4. Dr. Francis K. N. Nunoo, Green Communities International/ICESDA/KNUST
5. Mr. Alexander B. Amoakwa- Green Communities International/ICESDA/KNUST

E. Societal Impact Awards

1. T Gold Fields Ghana Limited
2. Jospong Group of Companies
3. Fidelity Bank Plc
4. McDan Group of Companies
5. Ing. Felix Atsrim, the CEO of FeDems Limited